

CUSTOMER SUPPORT ESCALATION & FOLLOW-UP SOP

Fictional example created to demonstrate operational documentation and workflow design.

PURPOSE

Ensure every customer request has a clear owner, documented status, appropriate escalation path, and verified closure.

SUCCESS STANDARD

Another team member can understand what happened, what remains open, and who owns the next action without reconstructing the case.

STANDARD WORKFLOW

STEP	STAGE	REQUIRED ACTION	OWNER	EXIT CRITERIA
1	Review	Read the full request, account history, prior notes, and any promised follow-up before responding.	Support	Issue and current status are understood.
2	Classify	Identify request type, urgency, missing information, and whether the issue is routine or requires escalation.	Support	Correct workflow and priority are selected.
3	Resolve	Complete approved actions and explain the outcome clearly. Do not guess when policy, authority, or technical facts are unclear.	Support	Routine issue is resolved OR escalation is required.
4	Escalate	Document the issue, evidence reviewed, actions attempted, business/customer impact, and the specific decision or help required.	Support -> Owner	Authorized owner has enough context to act.
5	Follow Up	Track open commitments, missing information, and promised actions. Re-contact the customer when status changes or a deadline is reached.	Assigned Owner	No promised action is untracked.
6	Close	Confirm resolution, record final action, disposition, and any recurring pattern that should be surfaced.	Support	Case is complete and auditable.

CASE NOTE STANDARD

SOURCE / CONTEXT	ACTION TAKEN	CURRENT STATUS
What the customer reported; account/history reviewed; relevant evidence.	What was changed, tested, explained, requested, or escalated.	Resolved, waiting on customer, waiting on internal owner, or scheduled follow-up.

ESCALATE - DO NOT ASSUME

- Required action exceeds documented authority or policy.
- Technical issue cannot be reproduced or resolved using approved troubleshooting.
- Information is conflicting, incomplete, or would require guessing.
- Issue involves security, privacy, payment risk, legal/compliance concerns, or sensitive customer impact.
- Customer has repeated the same unresolved issue or the failure appears systemic.